conceal con · ceal

Advanced Definition

transitive verb

1. to hide or keep hidden from sight.

   He concealed the gift in his desk so that it would be a surprise.
   The safe is concealed behind that painting.
   This makeup is supposed to conceal your skin's flaws.

2. to hide from discovery; keep secret.

   He gave some convincing reasons for his actions, but he concealed his true motives.
   While working as a spy, his real identity was concealed.

These are some examples of how the word or forms of the word are used:

1. The chameleon's ability to camouflage, or conceal itself by changing its appearance, helps the creature hide from predators and curious museum-goers.
2. I watched from my window for a few mindless minutes, entranced by the familiar view of industrial Brooklyn, ordinarily so locked and gridded but now softened by a blanket of snow, every edge rounded, every point concealed.
3. Startled onlookers watched as a veiled chameleon climbed up a tree branch and changed color. The chameleon’s ability to camouflage, or conceal itself by changing its appearance, helps the creature hide from predators and curious museum-goers.
4. Greg returned flushed, but smiling, the permit displayed proudly in his hand. “Where did you find it?” asked Sandy, trying to conceal her nervousness. “The strangest place. It was in the medicine cabinet…in your bathroom.” “How odd,” said Dad, as Greg pulled out of the driveway.
5. Otto Frank, Anne’s father, had built two rooms in his office. The rooms were concealed behind a bookcase that was a secret door. The family stayed in hiding for more than two years. Anne was in the two rooms from the time she was 13 until she was 15. The family had to be very quiet, especially during the day. Any noise could lead to their capture.
6. In 1838, after his owner threatened to take away his right to hire out his own time and keep a portion of his wages, Douglass decided to run away. With papers borrowed from a free black sailor, he boarded a train and rode to freedom. To conceal his identity, he adopted a new last name, Douglass, chosen from Sir Walter Scott's poem, “Lady of the Lake.”
7. He turns her around, makes her stoop, and walk; and then he takes off her turban to look at her head that no wound or disease be concealed by the gay handkerchief; he looks at her teeth, and feels of her arms, and at last announces himself pleased with the result of his observations, whereat Jeffrey, who has stood near, trembling with eager hope, is overjoyed, and he smiles for the first time.

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